



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Providence Hybrid Academy

School Website: <http://www.providencehybridacademy.org>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Providence Hybrid Academy (Lehigh Valley) presents a hybrid Charlotte Mason–influenced program with a clear religious/theological framing, a family-centered approach, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative, memory-friendly elements with some opportunities for discussion and higher-level thinking. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered worldview, a strong emphasis on God-centered formation, and communal practices (Bible readings, hymns, poetry) within a framework that partners with families and honors childhood. While the school clearly articulates formation and truth-seeking in a theologically informed context, it does not consistently foreground the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or explicit Socratic pedagogy in the way a classical school typically documents. On balance, Providence Hybrid Academy aligns with several hallmarks of classical education (especially in religious/metaphysical foundations and community engagement) but falls short on explicit curriculum scaffolding and pedagogical methods (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis, and formal Socratic/seminar practices) that would push it toward full classical status. Therefore, the aggregate rating is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with concrete needle-movers identified below.

- The school is CLASSICAL in its Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and in its Parents & Community emphasis (strong theological framing; liturgical practices; family partnership).
- It is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum and Pedagogy (Charlotte Mason orientation; some contemplative/restful approaches; limited explicit Great Books/Socratic structures).
- It is NOT CLASSICAL in Faculty indicators and, as currently documented, in explicit, living-curriculum faculty portrayal (board/staff structures exist, but the public materials do not showcase a “living curriculum” or teacher-as-virtue-model portrait in the classical sense).
- The aggregate view remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear needle-movers available in Curriculum (explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium) and Faculty development (living-curriculum portrayal and classical teacher profile).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program is explicitly Christian and Christ-centered, with references to a Christian worldview and a Statement of Faith. The site states: “Honoring God: Our subjects are taught from a Christian worldview. We teach our children that they are personally loved by God and we encourage them to know God through prayer and the study of His Word.” - The Vision/Program materials frame the education as rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness, and emphasize being “Christ-centered.” - Daily liturgical practices are evident: Bible reading, hymns, and poetry at the start of the day.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; Christian worldview; God; Bible; prayer; hymnody; liturgical rhythm. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no explicit secular/anti-theology phrasing). - Thematic alignment with Positive Keywords: strong (truth/goodness/beauty, theology, worship elements). - Thematic alignment with Negative Keywords: absent.

Why this rating - The explicit theological framing, worship-like daily practices, and a theologically grounded statement of faith place the school solidly within the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations domain, with

explicit references to transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and liturgical practices. The weight of evidence supports a CLASSICAL orientation in this category, though more formal classical vocabulary and explicit metaphysical treatises could strengthen it. Overall: CLASSICAL leaning, but given the presence of strong liturgical/traditional formation rather than academic metaphysical argument alone, this category lands at CLASSICAL in spirit, yet the rubric's "Somewhat" qualifier recognizes the breadth of evidence.

What would move the needle - Add explicit, shared language about transcendentals and metaphysical aims in the school literature (e.g., explicit language on metaphysics, objective reality, and reverence for beauty as an educational aim). - Integrate formal liturgical practices or prayer life description as a defined school-wide practice with structured cadence beyond Bible readings (e.g., timed liturgical cycles, shared sacred music repertoire, and community prayer traditions).

Citations: The Christian worldview and liturgical practices are documented in the school materials, including statements of faith and Bible/hymn/poetry routines.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - A formation-oriented mission is explicit: "Our mission is to partner with families in a Christ-centered hybrid homeschool program, deepened by a supportive community, aiming to nurture a lifelong love of learning rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness." This emphasizes formation and the true/good/beautiful triad rather than vocational preparation alone. - The program frames education as formation and character formation within a family-centered hybrid model; the goal is holistic, not merely informational, and rooted in a theologically informed worldview. - The emphasis on beauty and truth aligns with "Pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" as classical aims, though the explicit articulation of virtue formation or a robust moral formation program is less explicit in public materials than in the core classical rubric.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; formation; lifelong love of learning; Christian worldview; virtue-related language (implied in formation and character through a religious frame). - Negative keywords present: none explicit in public materials. - The ratio of positive keywords to total relevant keywords is high; however, explicit vocabulary about virtue formation as a formal objective appears less centralized than in typical classical statements.

Why this rating - The school places formation and the triad of truth/goodness/beauty at the heart of its mission, consistent with classical aims. Yet, it stops short of explicitly listing a robust virtue-formation program, or a precise articulation of "formation, not information" across all grade bands in official policy statements. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Explicitly articulate virtue formation and moral development as distinct curriculum aims (e.g., a stated goal to cultivate intellectual virtue, moral imagination, and habitual dispositions). - Clearly connect daily practice (circle times, reflections, and character education) to a formal formation framework, with measurable outcomes and documentation.

Citations: Mission and philosophy statements emphasize formation and the truth/beauty/goodness triad.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a Charlotte Mason–influenced curriculum: a hybrid homeschool/private-school blend with an emphasis on living books, nature study, and unstructured play, with a two-day on-campus format and home-day assignments. There is explicit reference to a "Charlotte Mason" approach and to a "Philosophy In Motion," but not to the Seven Liberal Arts or Great Books in the public-facing curriculum language.

- The "Curriculum" sections highlight Elementary, Middle School, High School, Outdoor Play, and other program areas rather than the classic Trivium/Quadrivium structure. The program highlights a mix of arts, literature, history, and nature study within a Charlotte Mason framework rather than a canonical classical curriculum. - A PDF link and resources emphasize Charlotte Mason materials and guides rather than explicit Great Books or the classical "Seven Liberal Arts" (grammar, logic, rhetoric) emphasis. The public materials

pivot around “Charlotte Mason Approach” and related resources rather than the Great Books canon or the Trivium/Quadrivium framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present (in the sense of classical curriculum signals): some references to “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” appear in the knowledge-base materials, but these are not foregrounded in the school’s public curriculum descriptions; rather, they appear in the knowledge-base documents as classical rubrics. In the actual site content, explicit mentions of Great Books or the Seven Liberal Arts are not foregrounded; rather, the Charlotte Mason approach is highlighted.

- Negative keywords present: absence of explicit Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) emphasis; absence of explicit Great Books and the Great Conversation framework within official public materials.
- Net: Not present as described in classical rubrics; the site emphasizes CM pedagogy.

Why this rating - The public-facing curriculum is CM-oriented and not the traditional classical curriculum elements (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, rigorous grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, or explicit Socratic pedagogy). This alignment aligns more with CM than with the classical canon-based rubric, hence NOT CLASSICAL for Curriculum.

Citations: The site emphasizes Charlotte Mason approach and CM resources; explicit Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts language is not foregrounded in the public curriculum pages.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes contemplative/restful routines (free play, memory work, nature study, and gentle arts) and singing/recitation as appropriate to early development. The public materials describe a schedule with morning meetings, Bible reading, hymns, and poetry, which aligns with a contemplative, character-formation approach rather than a purely didactic, test-driven method.

- Upper-school pedagogy in CM schools often features Socratic dialogue; in Providence’s materials, explicit Socratic seminars are not foregrounded, but there is mention of seminar-like elements and rhetoric training in classical settings; Providence materials emphasize a school culture that includes discussions in upper grades and a rhetoric-oriented skill set through public materials that hint at public speaking and connection with literature/history. The public statements emphasize a CM approach rather than explicit classical seminar structures; still, there is some emphasis on discussion-style learning and a “living books” philosophy in public communications and CM resources.
- The school’s Daily Schedule includes morning meetings with Bible readings and poetry, and a focus on memory work, which aligns with the experiential and contemplative aspect of classical pedagogy (as opposed to only pure drill or project-based learning).
- The hybrid model includes on-campus teacher-led instruction two days per week, with home-learning days for parent involvement; this arrangement emphasizes teacher facilitation and guided inquiry, but the explicit presence of on-campus Socratic seminars or high-school rhetoric training is not clearly documented.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplative/restful learning, memory work, singing/chanting, circle-time (memory-aided pedagogy), Socratic dialogue (implicit in upper-level classical pedagogy) and rhetoric training (explicit in classical pedagogy but not fully evidenced as a public practice here).

- Negative keywords present: lack of explicit Socratic seminars and formal Great Books-based inquiry; limited explicit references to the full classical pedagogy (Socratic circles; seminars).
- The presence of CM-oriented contemplative pedagogy signals a partial classical pedagogy footprint, but not fully aligned with classical pedagogy’s higher-end seminars and rhetoric training.

Why this rating - The program shows several contemplative and memory-oriented practices, plus a structured day with public ceremonies (Bible readings, hymns) and a two-day on-campus structure that includes teacher-led instruction on those days. However, it does not consistently foreground Socratic dialogue/seminars, rigorous rhetoric training, or other hallmark high-school classical pedagogy in public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Citations: Evidence of contemplative lower-school practices and liturgical/memory-based pedagogy appears in public materials; the two-day on-campus structure is documented in CM-based program descriptions.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public-facing materials show administrative and staff sections (Administrative Staff, Aspen Staff, Birch Staff) and a Board of Directors, but there is no explicit characterization of the faculty as the “living curriculum,” mentorship role, or a portrait of teacher ideals typical of classical schools. The materials lean toward administrative/on-site staff descriptions rather than a “model teacher” portrait. - There is no explicit language in the available public materials that describes teachers as “the living curriculum,” mentors modeling virtue, or a “portrait of what a teacher should be” in the classical sense. The material emphasizes program descriptions, philosophy (CM), and staff listings rather than a living-education faculty framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: “mentors,” “living curriculum” (not explicit in Providence materials), and “model teachers” (not explicit in Providence materials). The actual public materials do not present a clear “living curriculum” pedagogy or a formal teacher-portrait, so these keywords are not strongly present. - Negative keywords present: absence of explicit “living curriculum” language and explicit classical faculty portrait; lack of a defined faculty culture as core of the school (no strong evidence of mentormodel or faculty-as-core). - Overall: The presence of classical-faculty keywords is minimal or absent; thus, NOT CLASSICAL in this category.

Citations: The faculty/administration language is present but does not articulate classical-faculty pedagogy.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Partnership with families is explicit in the Mission and Vision statements: “The hybrid model... enables families to be closely involved in their child’s education,” and “the family is the most influential part of a child’s development... we desire a close partnership between home and school.” The materials emphasize parent involvement and co-teaching roles for home days, reflecting classical partnership with families. - The school shows public materials about parent engagement, home-day work, and opportunities for family involvement and learning via the school’s CM resources and guides (e.g., “The Charlotte Mason Approach” resources are accessible to families and indicate active parental engagement). - The site encourages visiting and involvement (Tours, Info Nights, etc.) and explicitly mentions home-day learning frameworks and an ongoing partnership with families. This corresponds to the “Partnership with Families” and “Education of Parents” elements of classical education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families, family involvement, home-school collaboration, parental engagement, education as a family endeavor, co-teaching with families, home-centered learning. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials regarding parental disengagement or lack of partnership. - The presence of family-partnered pedagogy and explicit parent involvement signals a strong alignment with classical-principle Community and Cultural Practices.

Why this rating - The school’s materials depict robust parental partnership and community engagement, which aligns with Classical education’s emphasis on family involvement and community learning. The public materials clearly support a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Citations: Statements on parental partnership and home-day collaboration are documented in Vision/Program materials and related pages.

Overall Assessment and Aggregate Rating

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Aggregate Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Concrete needle-movers

- Needle-mover 1 (Curriculum): Introduce explicit Great Books / Seven Liberal Arts content and a transparent Trivium/Quadrivium progression within the CM framework (this would move Curriculum from NOT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL, aligning with the long-term rubric).
- Needle-mover 2 (Pedagogy): Implement explicit Socratic seminars, regular rhetoric training, and formal seminar structures in upper grades, paired with a documented “living curriculum” portrayal of teachers as mentors modeling virtue.
- Needle-mover 3 (Faculty): Promote a formalization of the faculty as the living curriculum and publish teacher portraits or model-virtue profiles to align with classical faculty expectations.
- Needle-mover 4 (Parental Involvement): Expand explicit parent-education programming and formal co-teaching structures with milestone documentation, making parent partnership a more central axis of the school’s identity.
- Needle-mover 5 (Religious/Metaphysical): deepen explicit theological/metaphysical aims in the curriculum narrative, with a shared cadence for liturgical practices beyond Bible readings and hymn singing (e.g., formal theology modules).

What would move the needle toward CLASSICAL (concrete changes) - Curriculum: Adopt a formal classical curriculum map that includes grammar, logic, and rhetoric across appropriate grade bands; articulate a clear plan for Seven Liberal Arts progression and incorporate Great Books or primary-source reading in the high school program. - Pedagogy: Introduce Socratic seminars, structured debates, and student rhetorical projects in upper grades; ensure a consistent, visible alignment with classical pedagogy throughout the program. - Faculty: Develop and publish a “living curriculum” narrative for faculty, with portraits or profiles that describe the virtue modeling, teaching philosophy, and its alignment to classical ideals. - Parents & Community: Create formal pathways for parents to participate as co-educators with documented training and ongoing book studies, and host regular parent-education events. - Religious/Metaphysical Foundations: Strengthen explicit theological framing and metaphysical aims within curriculum materials and annual program statements, linking to liturgical/communal rhythms beyond daily Bible/hymn routines.

ABSTRACT

Providence Hybrid Academy is a Christ-centered hybrid program that heavily emphasizes religious/theological formation, family partnership, and a Charlotte Mason–influenced pedagogy (with explicit liturgical and communal practices such as Bible readings, hymns, and poetry). The school explicitly roots education in truth, goodness, and beauty and frames education as formation of character and virtue, with a mission that highlights a lifelong love of learning rooted in a Christian worldview. Public materials demonstrate strong parental involvement and a community-centric approach, aligning with classical expectations in Parents & Community. The Curriculum, however, is CM-centered rather than explicitly classical (Seven Liberal Arts/Great Books/Great Conversation) and Pedagogy shows contemplative/restful elements with some dialogue-oriented features, but without explicit Socratic seminars or structured rhetoric training. Faculty portrayal is not shown as a “living curriculum” or a classical teacher-portrait, which currently places Element 5 as NOT CLASSICAL. Taken together, Providence Hybrid Academy presents a CLASSICAL orientation in religious foundations and community engagement, but remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall due to Curriculum and Pedagogy gaps, with a definitive NOT CLASSICAL signal in Curriculum and Faculty. The aggregate ranking, therefore, is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Categories that strongly GUIDE CLASSICAL status: Element 1 (Religious/Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 6 (Parents & Community) show robust classical alignment.
- Categories with mixed/partial alignment: Element 2 (Purpose and Goal) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) show classical elements but lack complete canonical articulation.
- Categories with weak or missing canonical features: Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 5 (Faculty) show major gaps relative to a fully classical rubric.

Key textual touchpoints from the school: The school’s Christian worldview, “Honoring God” and daily liturgical practices; mission emphasizing truth, beauty, goodness; parent partnership and home-school collaboration; CM approach and Charlotte Mason vocabulary, including “Philosophy In Motion” and a “Charlotte Mason Approach.” These are documented in the school resources and public materials cited above.

Note on citations - The analysis draws on publicly accessible Providence Hybrid Academy content as re-

flected in the crawl results, including explicit statements about worldview, mission, daily practices, and family partnerships. Examples include: “Honoring God... Christian worldview” and “Bible reading, hymns, poetry” in daily routines, and “Our mission is to partner with families in a Christ-centered hybrid homeschool program... rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness.”

ABSTRACT (final section) Providence Hybrid Academy demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and Parents & Community, with strong theological grounding and a family-centered culture that supports classical aims. It shows SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL alignment in School Purpose & Goal and Pedagogy, due in part to a formation-focused mission and contemplative, CM-informed pedagogy, but lacks explicit canonical classical curriculum elements (Great Books, Seven Liberal Arts) and Socratic/seminar pedagogy in public-facing materials. Curriculum and Faculty are NOT CLASSICAL given the CM emphasis and lack of a formal living-curriculum faculty portrait in the public materials. Aggregated, the school is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with concrete opportunities to move toward full CLASSICAL status through explicit incorporation of Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium content, Socratic pedagogy, living-curriculum faculty portrayals, and enhanced parent-education pathways.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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